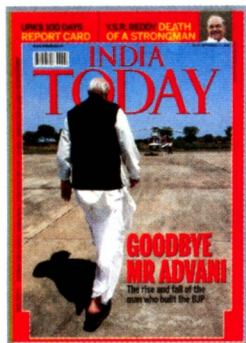


Goodbye Mr Advani

SEPTEMBER 14, 2009

Lal Krishna Advani made the BJP a party of governance, which marked a historic right turn in Indian politics. Today, as the party he built is on the verge of a nervous breakdown, he refuses to accept his own redundancy.



“ The biggest problem with the BJP is that they are trying to find Vajpayee in Advani. The latter is not Vajpayee's equal in stature and does not have the ability to hold his flock together. ”

BAL GOVIND, *Noida*

Right Turn

The RSS has intervened as an interlocutor and finally an arbiter (“An Inglorious Finale”, September 14). It has almost been decided that L.K. Advani will have a limited or no role. The RSS chief, however, should be aware of the miserable condition and the crisis the BJP is facing. Sycophancy and imperiousness is prevalent in the party. Therefore, it is mandatory for the RSS to introduce reformative steps and restructure the party in consonance with new ideas of the changing world.

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

The BJP's problems are more serious and complex than the party would like to admit. It can no longer pretend that it is independent of the RSS and



A Few Good Men

The rating of External Affairs Minister S.M. Krishna throws light on a trend that has also been seen in the past (“100 and Counting,” September 14). Most prime ministers have erred in the selection of a foreign minister. The choice, it seems, is guided more by the mien and the curriculum vitae of the politician rather than his ability to comprehend the implications of international issues on the national interest.

KRSNA KARNA, *Patna*

The UPA Government is burdened by poor performers—of 20 key ministers, only a fourth have done well in the its first 100 days. Most of the non-performers are the choice of the top leadership. When will Manmohan Singh select a meritorious team?

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

maintains an arms-length policy. The RSS has, through its actions, acknowledged that it is the true boss.

PADMINI RAGHAVENDRA,
via www.indiatoday.in

The Last Satrap

There are few chief ministers who genuinely deserve the sobriquet of ‘state strongman’ (“The Man of Action”, September 14). With a single-mindedness that had eluded previous chief ministers, Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy gave Andhra Pradesh's anti-Maoist commando force free rein. In a matter of months, the People's War Group and its guerrilla army had been decimated and key local commanders and mobilisers had been eliminated. The YSR model is now being scaled up and